

Day 1 — Build a Hook That Automates Something Meaningful

Challenge: build a Kiro hook that automates something meaningful and produces visible output in response to a change.

This build: *Branded PDF in Sync*. Every team ships documents — pitches, one-pagers, briefs — and every time, someone has to remember to drop them onto company letterhead. That manual step gets skipped, and off-brand PDFs go out the door. This hook removes the step entirely.

Any time you create or update a Markdown file in the watched docs/ folder, a Kiro hook fires and automatically (re)generates a matching **branded PDF** — same name, letterhead applied — so the polished document is always in sync with the source. No commands, no forgetting.

How it works

You create/edit a .md and save	Kiro hook fires	Branded output (i.e. PDF)
docs/sample-one-pager.md (the source of truth)	fileCreated / fileEdited runs md-to-branded-pdf.py	docs/sample-one-pager.pdf (logo + letterhead)

1. You create or edit a .md file in day-01-branded-pdf-hook/docs/ and save.
2. The hook Branded PDF in Sync (on create) (fileCreated) or Branded PDF in Sync (on update) (fileEdited) triggers.
3. It runs md-to-branded-pdf.py against the docs/ folder.
4. The matching branded PDF (<name>.pdf) is created or refreshed.

Why it does not loop

The hooks watch `*.md` and the script writes `*.pdf`, so generating the PDF can never re-trigger the hook. On top of that, the script only rebuilds a PDF when its Markdown source is newer, so re-runs are cheap no-ops.

Files

Path	Purpose
../.kiro/hooks/brand-md-on-create.kiro.hook	Hook: on <code>.md</code> created in docs/, build its branded PDF
../.kiro/hooks/brand-md-on-update.kiro.hook	Hook: on <code>.md</code> edited in docs/, refresh its branded PDF
scripts/md-to-branded-pdf.py	One-step engine: Markdown → branded PDF (letterhead overlay)
assets/logo.png	Company logo used on the letterhead
docs/sample-one-pager.md	Demo source document
docs/sample-one-pager.pdf	Branded PDF, generated and kept in sync by the hook

Try it

From the repo root:

```
# 1. Install dependencies (once)
pip install -r day-01-branded-pdf-hook/requirements.txt
```

With the hooks enabled in Kiro, just **edit docs/sample-one-pager.md and save** (or create a new `.md` in that folder) — the branded PDF appears/updates automatically. To run the sync by hand (what the hook runs under the hood):

```
python day-01-branded-pdf-hook/scripts/md-to-branded-pdf.py day-01-branded-pdf-hook/docs
```

Make it your own

Open `scripts/md-to-branded-pdf.py` and edit the branding config block near the top (`COMPANY_MARKER`, `CONTACT_PREFIX`, `CONTACT_LINK_TEXT`, `CONTACT_LINK_URL`) and drop your own `assets/logo.png`.

Submission details (copy/paste)

Challenge day: Day 1: Build a hook

Project name:

Branded PDF in Sync

Public GitHub repo link:

<https://github.com/dustin-lap1/kiro-birthday-challenges>

Demo video link:

<https://www.loom.com/share/74cdb04516164d4396bf5aec61ada56b>

Short description (2–3 sentences):

Branded PDF in Sync is a Kiro hook that keeps a company-branded PDF perfectly in sync with

How Kiro was used (150–300 words):

I built this entirely inside Kiro. I started from an existing manual "brand a PDF" script

The heart of the build is Kiro's agent hooks. My goal was simple: whenever I create or upd

We iterated on the design together. My first version watched PDFs, which risked an infinit

Kiro also wrote the sample doc, requirements file, and documentation, and ran the full pip

Social post (X or LinkedIn):

Day 1 of Kiro Birthday Week: I built a Kiro hook that keeps my docs on-brand automatically

Repo: <https://github.com/dustin-lap1/kiro-birthday-challenges>

#BuildWithKiro #TeamKiro @kirodotdev

Demo video script (~1–2 minutes)

Read the lines aloud; the cues in brackets are what to show on screen.

[0:00 — On camera or Kiro open, Agent Hooks panel visible] "Every team knows this pain: you write a document, export it, and forget to put it on company letterhead — so off-brand docs go out the door. For Day 1 of Kiro Birthday Week, I built a Kiro hook that keeps my docs on-brand automatically."

[0:15 — Show the two hooks in the Agent Hooks panel] "I've got two hooks watching my docs folder: one fires when I create a Markdown file, the other when I edit one. My Markdown is the source of truth — the branded PDF just stays in sync."

[0:30 — Open sample-one-pager.md side by side with the branded PDF] "Here's a one-pager in Markdown, and its branded PDF next to it. Watch what happens when I change the doc."

[0:45 — Edit a line in the Markdown and hit Save] "I'll tweak a headline and save."

[0:55 — The hook fires; the PDF regenerates] "The moment I save, the hook runs and the PDF regenerates itself — no button, no command."

[1:05 — Show the refreshed branded PDF] "Same document, on letterhead: my logo up top, a CONFIDENTIAL marker, and a footer with contact info and a clickable website link."

[1:20 — Optionally create a brand-new .md in docs/ and save] "And if I create a brand-new doc, its branded PDF appears automatically too."

[1:35 — Say it] "The clever part is it's loop-safe: the hook watches Markdown and writes PDF, so it can never trigger itself, and it only rebuilds when the source actually changed."

[1:50 — Close] "One hook, something genuinely useful, built with Kiro. That's Day 1."